

Ellettsville Town Council Meeting Minutes January 14, 2026

The meeting was called to order at 7:00 PM by Mayor Smith.
Present: Council members Jones, Brown, Davis, and Williams.
Absent: None. A quorum was established.

Approval of Minutes:

The minutes from the December 22, 2025 meeting were presented for approval. Council member Brown moved to approve as written. Council member Davis seconded. Motion carried unanimously.

Old Business:

The council discussed the road repair budget for 2026. Public Works Director Anderson presented an updated scope including Main Street, Oak Avenue, and Cedar Lane. After review and discussion with the committee, a motion was made to allocate \$12,500.00 for pothole repairs on Main Street. The motion passed unanimously.

The council also received an update on the ongoing drainage project on Highland Road. Engineer consulting fees to date totaled \$3,275.00. Completion is expected by March 2026.

New Business:

The Parks Department requested approval for a new playground equipment purchase totaling \$47,850.00. Director Thompson presented the proposal including safety certifications and installation estimates. The equipment would be installed at Community Park over the summer.

The council also reviewed the quarterly financial report showing \$1,234,567 in total expenditures for Q4 2025. The report highlighted increased costs in snow removal due to the harsh December weather.

Motion to approve the playground purchase carried 4-1.

Budget Amendments:

The council considered amendment 2026-01 to reallocate \$8,400 from the general fund to the emergency services line item. This was driven by unexpected equipment replacement at the fire station. The amendment passed 5-0.

Discussion of the water treatment facility upgrades continued on page two of these minutes. Engineer Martinez presented three options ranging from \$89,000 to \$156,000 for the upgraded filtration system. Each option was evaluated against the town's five-year capital plan.

Option A, at \$89,000, offered minimum compliance with new state regulations but limited future capacity. Option B, at \$112,500, included additional capacity for projected growth through 2030. Option C, at \$156,000, added redundancy and remote monitoring.

After extensive discussion, the council voted to proceed with Option B at \$112,500. The motion carried 4-1, with Council member Williams voting against due to concerns about contractor availability.

Public Comments:

Resident Mary Johnson requested additional street lighting on Elm Street. She cited safety concerns for evening pedestrians near the elementary school. The request was referred to the Public Works committee for review at their February meeting.

Resident Robert Chen raised concerns about the frequency of trash

collection in the downtown district. The council acknowledged the concern and directed staff to contact the waste management vendor regarding increased service frequency.

Announcements:

The next regular council meeting is scheduled for January 28, 2026 at 7:00 PM in the Town Hall chambers. The agenda deadline is January 23, 2026.

The meeting was adjourned at 9:15 PM.

Respectfully submitted,
Town Clerk